



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: It's time to proofread!



Learning Outcome

Describe necessity, duty, advice, or strong disapproval in written and spoken situations according to work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Do you consider yourself a good proofreader?
- What do you look for when you are checking your work?

Can Do Statements

- I can write about what needs to be done or needs doing.
- I can explain how I will do certain tasks in my job in a written way.
- I can express my work responsibilities.





Let's Explore!

When proofreading a manuscript, there is often a **firm*** deadline.

* "Firm" means not likely to change.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

There are so many things that need to be considered when proofreading. The boss wanted to know when I would have it finished. I asked if there was a deadline and she said, "I expect it on my desk by 9 a.m." Having taken the early train to work since I started, today might be the day that I drive to the office. It will give me more time to finish proofreading. I suppose I should get cracking on this although the time I spend at night working needs reconsidering.

Here are the main areas I want to cover when reading over the manuscript: Spotting too many problems at one time can leave a proofreader frustrated and overwhelmed. Focus on one type of problem at a time. When writing at speed, there can be a tendency to forget small words that don't impact the meaning of the sentence. Some experts suggest that manuscripts need to be read under your breath to help identify pesky mistakes. While reading through a text, you can concentrate on different areas like sentence structure, then word choice, then spelling, and finally, punctuation. Sometimes sentences need trimming. Run-on sentences are not acceptable. Double-checking facts, figures, and proper names is essential. Factual information needs to be verified before it is published. Does the information need rearranging? Consider moving content up or down the page. After printing out the manuscript, you are better able to review it line by line. It may help you catch errors that you previously missed. A spellchecker can help you catch repeated words, reversed letters, and many other common errors. Creating your own checklist while proofreading can help you reflect on common mistakes and patterns.





Let's Practice!

What needs to happen?

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentences. Write the sentences in the correct order. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. Factual / before / needs / to be / verified / it / is / information / published / .

2. the / information / rearranging / ? / Does / need

3. many / are / so / that / There / need / to be / considered / things / when / proofreading / a / manuscript / .



Let's Practice!

How will Kristi complete the task before the deadline?

Instructions: Choose the words from the word bank to correctly complete the sentences.

Word Bank

having taken / review / proofreading / reading over / impact

1. _____ the early train to work since I started, today might be the day that I drive to the office.
2. Here are the main areas I want to cover when _____ the manuscript.
3. After organizing my office. I will start thinking about _____ the manuscript.
4. When writing at speed, there can be a tendency to forget small words that don't _____ the meaning of the sentence.
5. After printing out the manuscript, you are better able to _____ it line by line which may help you catch errors that you previously missed.



Extension Activity

Time to create your own proofreading sheet.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Make a list of the 10 most common mistakes you make in your writing.
- Then, design a checklist that you can use each time you complete a writing activity. You can use this checklist before you hand in your work to your teacher.
- Compare your checklist with a partner's. Do you often make the same mistakes or are they different?
- Decide on one area you are going to focus on to improve each week.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I make a list of common errors in my writing.

☐
☐

I create a proofreading checklist I can use in class.

☐
☐

I compare my list with a partner's list.

☐
☐


Target Words

- **tendency** (noun): to an inclination toward a way of being or type of behavior.
e.g. I have the tendency to read over manuscripts too quickly.
- **to impact** (verb): to have a strong effect on someone or something.
e.g. When writing at speed, there can be a tendency to forget small words that don't impact the meaning of the sentence.
- **under your breath** (expression): saying something quietly to yourself
e.g. Did you say something under your breath?
- **pesky** (adjective): causing trouble; annoying
e.g. Some experts suggest that manuscripts need to be read aloud to help identify pesky mistakes.
- **content** (noun): created material
e.g. Consider moving content up or down the page.
- **spellchecker** (noun): a computer program that locates the words that are not spelt correctly
e.g. A spellchecker can help you catch repeated words, reversed letters, and many other common errors.





Learning Points

Need + Passive infinitive and Need + verb+ing

Need + passive infinitive and need + verb+ing are two structures you use to talk about fixing problems.

You use these structures to imply that we don't know who will fix the problem, or that the person fixing the problem is not the focus of the sentence.

Subject + Need + Passive Infinitive

The manuscript needs to be looked at first.

The subject of the sentence is the thing that needs fixing/to be fixed.

Subject + Need + Verb + ing

That article needs proofreading.

Examples:

- *Factual information needs to be verified before it is published.*
- *Your work needs to be finished before you leave.*
- *Does the information need rearranging?*
- *There are so many things that need to be considered when proofreading a manuscript.*
- *Manuscripts need to be read under your breath to help identify pesky mistakes.*
- *The time I spend at night working needs reconsidering.*
- *Do any other manuscripts need proofreading before 9 a.m?*





Learning Points

Clauses using -ing

When you use a clause with verb + ing, there are some rules you need to keep in mind. You can use a clause with a gerund (verb + ing) as the subject or the complement of a sentence.

As the subject:

***When writing at speed**, there can be a tendency to forget small words that don't impact the meaning of the sentence.*

As the complement:

*There can be a tendency to forget small words that don't impact the meaning of the sentence **when writing at speed**.*

A complement is a group of words that give another word more meaning. You can use them after adjectives.

Other clauses with v-ing come after prepositions:

*I can get that done quickly **by organizing my time better**.*

Examples:

- *After printing out the manuscript, you are better able to review it line by line.*
- *Double-checking facts, figures, and proper names is essential.*

